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The White Paper and the Communal Award[1]

THE proposals contained in the White Paper issued in March 1933, represented the tentative conclusions arrived at by the British Government after three sessions of the Round Table Conference. According to this scheme, India is no longer to be divided into British India ruled directly by the British Government, and the Indian States ruled by Indian Princes or Rulers or Maharajahs under the suzerainty of the British Crown. India is to be a Federation composed of the provinces of British India, eleven in number including Sindh and Orissa, and such of the Indian States as would voluntarily join the Federation. Those Rulers who signify their desire to join the Federation will have to execute a formal Instrument of Accession transferring to the British Crown for the purposes of the Federation their powers and jurisdiction in respect of those matters which they are willing to recognise as Federal matters. The powers and jurisdiction so transferred will be exercised by the appropriate Federal organs created by the new Constitution Act. The Federation will be brought into existence by the issue of a Proclamation by His Majesty, the King-Emperor, but the proclamation will not be issued until :

1. His Majesty has received intimation that the Rulers of States representing not less than half the aggregate population of the Indian States and entitled to not less than half the seats to be allotted to the States in the Federal Upper Chamber have signified their desire to accede to the Federation; and

[1] This chapter gives only a rough idea of the provisions of the White Paper and the Communal Award For further details which are uninteresting to the general reader one should refer to *Proposals for Indian Constitutional Reform* 1933, printed and published by His Majesty's Stationery Office, Adastral House, Kingsway, London, W C 2 Price 2s nett